# Business Canvas Project — Assignment 2.4

## Unit 2 Task 5: Build the MVP → Prove Product-Market Fit → Write the Value Proposition → Design the Brand · AP Topic 2.4

> **Due:** _____
> **Team size:** Same team as Assignments 1A, 1.3, 1.4-1.5, 1C, Unit 1 Final Canvas, 2.1, 2.2 and 2.3 (up to 3)
> **Submission:** Your Business Canvas **Product** section — a **minimum viable product with the evidence that it found (or did not find) product-market fit**, a **value proposition** in one line, and a **brand identity** with the test that a stranger can tell it apart. Plus: what the MVP cost you per unit.
>
> Everything so far has been a claim about a business. **This is the checkpoint where the thing itself has to exist.** Unit 1 asked *is the problem real?*; 2.1 asked *who exactly buys?*; 2.2 asked *why does a person say yes at the stall?*; 2.3 asked *what does the data actually say?* 2.4 asks the only question that turns an idea into a company: **can you build a smallest-version of it that a real stranger will pay real money for — and can you say, in one line, why they should?**
>
> **CED Unit 2 Task 5:** "*Develop a minimum viable product (MVP), to assess product-market fit, a value proposition, and branding/brand identity.*" Two of those three elements — **MVP** and **branding/brand identity** — are **asterisked in the CED: they require hypothesis testing.** The value proposition is not asterisked: it needs reasoning and research, not a test.
>
> **Review first:** [[2.4 Product - Vocab]] · [[2.4 Product - Slides]] · [[2.4 Product - Summary]] · [[2.4 Dyson - Case Handout]] · [[2.4 Genki Forest - Case Handout]] · [[2.3 Market Research - Vocab]]

## Deliverables

| Canvas Section | What You Submit | AP Topic | CED Task |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Product** | **MVP** — what you built, what it cost per unit, the **product-market-fit test you ran on it** (behaviour, not opinion) and the verdict | 2.4 | Unit 2 Task 5 · LO 2.4.A |
| **Product** | **Value proposition** — one line: who + what problem + why us, with the research behind each of the three parts | 2.4 | Unit 2 Task 5 · LO 2.4.A |
| **Product** | **Branding / brand identity*** — name, term, symbol or design; the three jobs it does; consistency across touchpoints; a recognition/differentiation test | 2.4 | Unit 2 Task 5 · LO 2.4.B |
| **Market** | **Positioning** — how the customer sees you against **both** of your rivals (from 1A and 2.3) | 2.4 | LO 2.4.A |

| Canvas Section | What You Submit | AP Topic | CED Task |
|---|---|---|---|
| — | **Copy stress test** — what happens the day a rival photocopies your tag, your name or your promise | 2.4 (→2.4.C, 2.2) | LO 2.4.C |

> **Two asterisks, one rule.** *MVP* and *branding/brand identity* both require hypothesis testing. The CED is explicit that **product-market fit** is achieved "*when customer demand is sufficient to generate profit*" — which means your evidence must include **money**, not enthusiasm. A free demo that everyone loved is a **usage** signal, not a **fit** signal.

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## Where This Fits — Project Progress

| # | Checkpoint | Topics | Assignment | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Customer problem + competitors + competitive advantage plan | 1.1, 1.2 | Assignment 1A | ✅ Done |
| 2 | PESTEL analysis + market verdict | 1.3 | Assignment 1.3 | ✅ Done |
| 3 | Validation interviews + product idea + hypothesis test + vision & mission | 1.4, 1.5 | Assignment 1.4-1.5 | ✅ Done |
| 4 | Production process + supply chain plan | 1.8 | Assignment 1C | ✅ Done |
| 5 | Commit to the idea + revised market analysis + integrated canvas | 1.1–1.8 | Unit 1 Final Canvas | ✅ Done |
| 6 | Target customer profile + plan to build customer relationships | 2.1 | Assignment 2.1 | ✅ Done |
| 7 | Sales tactic drawing on principles of persuasion | 2.2 | Assignment 2.2 | ✅ Done |
| 8 | Primary + secondary research, competitive landscape, data visualization | 2.3 | Assignment 2.3 | ✅ Done |
| **9** | **MVP + product-market fit + value proposition + brand identity** | **2.4** | **This assignment** | 🔵 Current |
| 10 | Pricing strategy | 2.5 | | ⬜ |
| 11 | Marketing channel(s) | 2.6 | | ⬜ |
| 12 | Marketing campaign + digital marketing tools | 2.7 | | ⬜ |

**Suggested pacing (≈4 class periods, matching the CED's 4 periods for Topic 2.4):**

| Milestone | By | You bring to class |
|---|---|---|
| **M1 — Scope cut + build plan** | Day 1 | Section 1 (raw material vs. product) + Section 2 Steps 1–2 complete: the MVP you can actually build, the features you are cutting, and the per-unit cost estimate |
| **M2 — Fit test designed and approved** | Day 2 | Section 2 Step 3: hypothesis in strict form + **pre-set behavioural** success criteria + who you will put it in front of. **No unit goes to a customer before this is approved.** |
| **M3 — Test run** | Day 3–4 | Section 2 Steps 4–5: the money/commitment numbers, the verdict, and the change you made |
| **M4 — Submit** | Day 4 | Sections 3–5 complete: value proposition line, brand elements + recognition test, copy stress test; full worksheet submitted |

> **The build is not the deliverable. The evidence is.** A beautiful prototype nobody paid for has proved nothing; an ugly one that produced three real orders has proved something. Do not spend the week building and the weekend "testing" — design the test first (M2), then build only what the test needs.

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## Before You Start: The Framework

**Seven rules from the 2.4 lesson that this worksheet runs on:**

1. **Raw material ≠ product** (EK 2.4.A.1). A raw material is the input you start with; the product is **what the customer pays for**. Keep this straight the whole way — it is the most common way a Product section goes wrong.
2. **You are joining a six-stage sequence in the middle.** Ideation → Validation → **Design → Messaging** → Production → Launch. 2.4 does Design (Section 2), Messaging (Section 3) and the start of Branding (Section 4). Your 2.3 findings are the research that the value proposition must be built **from** — not decorated with.
3. **MVP = the simplest sellable version that lets real customers vote with real dollars.** It is not a prototype shown to friends; it is an offer with a price and a way to commit. **Product-market fit** = demand sufficient to **generate profit**.
4. **Design is three dimensions, priced from cost data. Functionality** (how it works), **user experience** (how the customer encounters it), **attributes** (measurable features). And the design sets the cost: parts, delivery time, hours.
5. **Value proposition = who + what problem + why us** — a statement built from market research. **Positioning** = how the customer perceives you **relative to rivals** (both of them, not your favourite one).
6. **A brand is a name, term, design, symbol or combination that identifies and differentiates** your product; branding has **three jobs** — distinguish, raise awareness, generate loyalty. It can travel through any of those forms. **Trademarks** give legal protection against imitation; **generic products** are the honest alternative for buyers who prioritise cost over brand.
7. **Brand equity is earned, not bought** — the added financial and competitive value a product gains because customers recognise, trust and prefer it, built through **consistency**

**across every touchpoint**. It is also what a copycat cannot photocopy, which is why Section 5 asks you to be copied on purpose.

> **Strong-answer method (all through this worksheet):**
> **State the evidence (money or number) → name the concept (LO/EK) → tie it to YOUR product, YOUR customer, YOUR price.**

**Four standing clauses carried over from 1C and 2.1 — they apply here in full:**

1. **The asterisked tests must be able to fail**, and behaviour beats attitude. "*Would you buy this?*" is an opinion; *paying, pre-ordering, returning, referring* are evidence. If you did not run the test, mark it **PENDING** with the recording plan — never write a verdict with nothing behind it.
2. **Numbers must be checkable and consistent.** One unit cost, one unit price, one currency, across 1.8, 2.1, 2.3 and this file. State fixed/variable split; state LTV horizons; the MVP's cost per unit feeds 2.5 directly.
3. **Concept application, not metaphor.** Do not call a logo a "brand identity" if it does nothing for the customer; do not call a free trial a "MVP test of product-market fit" — an MVP must be capable of producing a **sale**.
4. **Self-check integrity.** Tick a box only if you can point at the sentence that earns it.

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## SECTION 1: WHAT ARE YOU ACTUALLY SELLING?

*AP Topic 2.4 · LO 2.4.A · EK 2.4.A.1*

### 1A. Raw material vs. product

| | What it is | Your answer |
|---|---|---|
| **Raw material** | the input you start with | |
| **Product** | what the customer pays for | |
| **The transformation you sell** | what you add between the two | |

> **Model from the lesson:** the used bike from a storage-unit auction is Theo's **raw material**; the **certified ready-to-ride bike with a signed 21-point inspection tag** is his **product**. The parent at the rack paid for the second thing — she never asked about a single component.
>
> **Use this test on your own project:** if a customer could get your "product" by buying the raw material herself, **you are not selling a product yet — you are reselling an input.** Write the sentence: "*We are not selling ____ ; we are selling ____.*"

### 1B. What your earlier checkpoints already decided about the product

| Source | What it said | What it forces the product to be |
|---|---|---|
| 1.4-1.5 — validated problem | | |
| 2.1 — target customer profile | | |
| 2.2 — your chosen sales tactic | | |
| 2.3 — your strongest research finding | | |

> **If a row is empty, the product is not designed yet — it is guessed.** Each of these four rows should hand you a concrete requirement (a size, a price ceiling, a proof, a delivery moment).

**Self-check:**

- ☐ I can state my raw material and my product as two different things — EK 2.4.A.1
- ☐ Every product feature I plan traces back to 1.4-1.5, 2.1, 2.2 or 2.3 — LO 2.4.A

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## SECTION 2: UNIT 2 TASK 5 (a) — DESIGN AND BUILD THE MVP, THEN TEST PRODUCT-MARKET FIT

*AP Topic 2.4 · LO 2.4.A · EK 2.4.A.1, 2.4.A.2 · CED Unit 2 Task 5 · **[asterisked — hypothesis testing required]** *

### Step 1 — Design the product in three dimensions

| Dimension | Meaning | Your answer |
|---|---|---|
| **Functionality** | how it works — the mechanical layer | |
| **User experience** | the buying layer — how the customer encounters it | |
| **Attributes** | basic measurable features (size, material, quality bar, colour, count) | |

### Step 2 — Cut the scope to an MVP, and cost it

**MVP = the simplest version that can produce a real sale.** Name what you are deliberately **not** building yet.

| Line | Your answer |
|---|---|
| The one job the MVP must do | |
| Features cut for version 2 | |

| Line | Your answer |
|---|---|
| Units you can actually build (number) | |
| **Materials/parts cost per unit** | ¥ / $ |
| **Your own labour time per unit** (hours → priced) | |
| Delivery/fulfilment cost per unit | |
| **Total cost per unit** | |
| **Price you will offer it at** | |
| **Contribution per unit (price − cost)** | |

> **The cost column is not bookkeeping — it is the design.** Theo's notebook averages put parts near $18 per commuter rebuild, and his early buyers ignored scratched paint and squeezed the brake levers first, so the rebuild hours moved **from cosmetics to brakes**. Design pins down what the product is; feedback tells you what the customer actually cares about.
>
> **CAUTION — your own hours go in the cost line.** A "free" MVP is not free; it is paid in your time. If contribution per unit is only positive because nobody charged you for labour, say so explicitly.

## Step 3 — The product-market-fit test — designed BEFORE anything is sold

> **Hypothesis (variable → measure → expected number → clock):**
> "We will offer ____ (the MVP) at ____ price to ____ people who match my 2.1 profile, and at least ____ will ____ (a behaviour: pay, pre-order with a deposit, book a slot, return for a second unit) within ____."
>
> **Success criteria — set NOW, before the first offer goes out:** _____
> *Shape to aim for: "≥3 of 10 pay ¥15 at the point of offer, and ≥1 of those returns within 14 days." Not "people say it looks good."*
>
> **This criterion must be able to fail.** If every outcome passes, rewrite it.
>
> **What we will do if it fails** (three options — pick the one you commit to now): re-scope the product / re-target the segment / re-price → _____

## Step 4 — Run it and record the money

| Offered to (n, and how you reached them) | Paid / committed | Returned or reordered | Referred someone unprompted | Revenue − cost |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |

> **Interview discipline carried over from Unit 1 and 2.1:** record **what they did** separately from **what they said**. "Praise the dish, then never come back" is a real pattern — politeness is not data. And state your recruitment channel: if the ten people who "committed" are classmates who could not say no to you, that is **convenience sampling** and the fit claim is weaker — write the caveat yourself.

### Step 5 — The verdict — and this is the graded part

> **What the numbers said:** _____
>
> **Fit verdict:** supported / partially / **not supported** — against the criterion you set in Step 3 (not a new one)
>
> **What changed as a result** (product scope / price / feature priority / target / proof) **and why:** _____
>
> **What this test cannot claim** (n, sample, time window, season, who recruited): _____
>
> **The cleanest signal — did you get one?** An **unprompted referral** — a stranger asking for the product because an existing buyer told them, with **zero marketing spent** — is the strongest fit signal a small business gets. Did one happen? Y / N: _____

> **Model from the lesson:** Theo's first sale was $90 − $35 = **$55 earned because the checklist earned the buyer's trust.** One profitable sale **hints** at fit. The **confirmation** came two weeks later, when a stranger he had never contacted asked for a checked bike because the first buyer had sent him.
> **Model at scale:** Dyson's **G-Force** launched in Japan in 1986 at **$2,000** — an expensive, tiny-market offer used to test whether anyone would pay for cyclone technology. That is an **MVP with a price**, not a prototype in a lab. The 5,127 prototypes came with **design**; the Japan launch came with **customers**.

**Self-check:**

- ☐ Design answered all three dimensions and the cost line includes **my own labour** — EK 2.4.A.1
- ☐ My MVP is capable of producing a **sale**, not only a demo — LO 2.4.A
- ☐ Hypothesis has variable + measure + number + clock, and the criterion **could have failed** — CED Unit 2 Task 5
- ☐ Criteria and the if-it-fails action were written **before** the first offer — CED Unit 2 Task 5
- ☐ Results reported as **money and counts with a base**, and behaviour kept separate from politeness — CED Unit 2 Task 5
- ☐ I wrote the sentence about what the test **cannot** claim — LO 2.4.A
- ☐ One real canvas change is documented because of the numbers — CED Unit 2 Task 5

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## SECTION 3: UNIT 2 TASK 5 (b) — VALUE PROPOSITION AND POSITIONING

*AP Topic 2.4 · LO 2.4.A · EK 2.4.A.2*

### Step 1 — Write the value proposition in one line

A value proposition is built **from market research** and names three things: **who** the product serves · **what** problem or need it addresses · **why** it beats the alternatives.

| Part | Your answer | The evidence behind it (from 2.1 / 2.3 / Section 2) |
|---|---|---|
| **Who** it serves | | |

| Part | Your answer | The evidence behind it (from 2.1 / 2.3 / Section 2) |
|---|---|---|
| **What problem / need** | | |
| **Why us** (the edge) | | |

> **Model from the lesson — one line on the tag:** "*Half of retail. Inspected. Guaranteed 30 days.*" Who: parents buying a first commuter bike. What: a safe bike without the new-bike price. Why us: a documented inspection and a guarantee no other table offers.
> **Model from the case:** Dyson's "*Say goodbye to the bag*" — a problem statement (suction loss), not a feature list.

## Step 2 — Positioning: your two rivals, at once

| Rival | Same need, different offer | Your position against them |
|---|---|---|
| **Rival 1 — the up-market option** | | |
| **Rival 2 — the cheap/unverified option** | | |

> **Model from the lesson — Theo is positioned against both at once:** against the bike shop (new bikes) he is **same safety, half the price**; against the driveway sale (unchecked used) he is **same price, 21 checks safer**.
> **Write both rows.** "We're cheaper than the shop" is only half a position — the rival you have not answered is the one your customer will actually compare you to on their phone while standing in front of you.

## Step 3 — Claim audit

Your value proposition and brand claims will be believed only as far as they are **provable in the customer's hand**.

| Claim you are making | Can the customer verify it? | How you prove it | Claim to delete or downgrade if unprovable |
|---|---|---|---|
| | Y / N | | |
| | Y / N | | |

> **From 2.2's face test, carried into 2.4:** a claim that dies when a buyer asks "*who checked it?*", "*how many?*" or "*show me*" must be cut now, not after launch. Faked scarcity and borrowed credentials do the opposite of brand equity — they cost you the trust you are trying to charge for.

**Self-check:**

- ☐ One line, with who + what problem + why us, each backed by a named finding — EK 2.4.A.2

- ☐ Positioning written against **both** rivals — LO 2.4.A
- ☐ Every public claim is verifiable by the customer, or downgraded — LO 2.4.B

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## SECTION 4: UNIT 2 TASK 5 (c) — BRAND IDENTITY

*AP Topic 2.4 · LO 2.4.B · EK 2.4.B.1, 2.4.B.2, 2.4.B.3 · CED Unit 2 Task 5 · **[asterisked — hypothesis testing required]** *

### Step 1 — Build the identity

A brand identity can travel through a **name, an idea, a term, a symbol, a design, or any combination**. Fill at least three rows.

| Element | Your choice | Why it signals what you sell |
|---|---|---|
| **Name** | | |
| **Term / idea** | | |
| **Symbol or colour** | | |
| **Design / packaging / physical artefact** | | |
| **Voice** (how you say it) | | |

> **Model from the lesson:** the **orange tag** — a physical inspection certificate zip-tied to the handlebars, proof you can *hold*; and the name **Trued Cycles** — "trued" is the mechanic's term for bending a warped wheel back to round, so the name says *a used thing restored to true*, in one word.

### Step 2 — The three jobs: does each element actually do one?

| Job of a brand | Which element does it | How will you know it worked? |
|---|---|---|
| **Distinguish** from competitors | | |
| **Raise awareness** in the target segment | | |
| **Generate loyalty** (return + refer) | | |

### Step 3 — Consistency across touchpoints (equity is built here, not in the logo)

| Touchpoint | What the customer sees | Does it say the same thing as the value proposition? |
|---|---|---|
| The product itself | | |
| Packaging / physical proof | | |
| Listing / post / ad | | |

| Touchpoint | What the customer sees | Does it say the same thing as the value proposition? |
|---|---|---|
| Chat or in-person pitch | | |
| After-sale (receipt, follow-up, guarantee) | | |

> **Model case from the lesson — the 茶颜悦色 standard:** one-city scarcity for seven years, real customer posts, a stamp card, seasonal flavours that genuinely disappear — every touchpoint telling the same story, and every tactic surviving full disclosure. **That consistency is the equity.**
> **Model at scale — Dyson:** "We engineer things better" carried through industrial design, premium pricing, and roughly **6,000 patents** protecting the engineering claim. The brand is the promise; the patents are how the promise stays unfakable.

## Step 4 — Protect it or not? (trademark and the generic option)

| Question | Your answer and reason |
|---|---|
| Which element would you **trademark**, if any? (a name protects the name; a symbol protects the mark) | |
| What does a copycat gain if they use it anyway, and what would it cost you? | |
| Do you have customers who **refuse to pay for branding**? (Would a **generic product** — unbranded, priced on cost — be a better offer for them?) | |

> **Generic is a legitimate strategy, not a failure.** A shopper on a $40 budget who walks past the branded rack for the cheapest untagged option is a real segment, and store-brand cereal beats the name brand on the same logic. The exam asks you to **choose**, and to know the trade: branded = higher price supported by equity; generic = lower price, no brand premium.

## Step 5 — Test the identity (the asterisked part)

> **Hypothesis:** "If we show our brand elements to ____ people who match the 2.1 profile, at least ____ will, without being told, (a) tell it apart from a rival's, and (b) name the promise we are making."
>
> **Success criterion, set before you ask: _____**

| Person shown (n, how recruited) | Picked ours out of a line-up? Y/N | In their words, what do we promise? | Did the promise arrive? |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |

> **Verdict and what changed: _____**
>
> **What this test cannot claim: _____**

> **Model from the lesson — Theo's tag passes this test in the wild:** the parent read all 21 checklist lines, asked who signed the bottom, heard that Theo signs every inspection himself, **and bought the bike without asking about a single component.** The certification did the selling. If your brand element cannot do that to a stranger, it is decoration, not identity.

**Self-check:**

- ☐ Identity uses at least two of name / term / symbol / design and each is justified by what it signals — EK 2.4.B.1
- ☐ All three jobs of a brand are assigned to a specific element — LO 2.4.B
- ☐ Every touchpoint says the same thing (or I listed the one that doesn't) — LO 2.4.B
- ☐ I made an explicit trademark decision **and** an explicit generic-vs-branded decision — EK 2.4.B.2, 2.4.B.3
- ☐ The recognition/recall test has a pre-set, falsifiable criterion, real respondents and a verdict — CED Unit 2 Task 5
- ☐ Brand equity is described as earned through consistency, not bought — LO 2.4.B

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## SECTION 5: THE COPY STRESS TEST

*AP Topic 2.4 · LO 2.4.C · with 2.2.C and 1.8.C.3*

Your brand and your proof will be copied — the only question is whether the copy survives contact with a customer who asks.

> **Scenario:** next Saturday, a rival sets up beside you selling the same category, with a **photocopied version of your tag / your list format / your name's phrasing**, at a slightly lower price.

| Question | Your answer |
|---|---|
| Which **one** of our elements costs a copycat real money to match (skill, proof, signature, warranty, licence, capacity, relationship)? | |
| What do we say to the customer that a copier **cannot** say without lying? | |
| Where is the line we will **not** cross to beat them on price (what would make our claim false)? | |
| Which stage of the life cycle is our product in, and what does that change about this fight? (cite your sales evidence, not the calendar) | |

> **Model from the lesson:** when a Saturday rival turned up with **photocopied inspection sheets**, Theo's answer was a **signature on every tag** and a **30-day guarantee** — two things that cost a copycat real money, not a prettier poster.
> **Model from 1.8 (your own work):** your supplier design, your proof/archive, your vetting and your points of access are exactly where barriers come from. Say which one holds.

**Self-check:**

- ☐ I named one element a copycat cannot match at zero cost, and why
- ☐ I named the claim I will not inflate under price pressure
- ☐ I placed my product's life-cycle stage on **sales evidence**, not age — LO 2.4.C

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## SECTION 6: EXAM DRILL — The Tells

| # | Item | Classification | One-sentence reason (name the tell) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | A used bike bought at auction, before any work | raw material / product | |
| 2 | The signed 21-point inspection card on the handlebar | raw material / product | |
| 3 | One $35 repaired bike sold for $90 to a stranger | MVP / prototype / launch | |
| 4 | Three classmates say "that's cool" but nobody pays | fit evidence / not fit evidence | |
| 5 | A stranger asks for your product because a buyer told them | strongest fit signal / weakest | |
| 6 | "Half of retail. Inspected. Guaranteed 30 days." | value proposition / positioning / slogan | |
| 7 | "Safer than the driveway sale, half the price of the shop" | value proposition / positioning | |
| 8 | The name "Trued Cycles" | brand element / product feature | |
| 9 | Registering the orange tag so no stall can hang one | trademark / patent / generic | |
| 10 | A cereal sold plain and cheap because buyers won't pay for a name | brand equity / generic product | |
| 11 | Sales climbing fast and two copycats just appeared | PLC stage | |
| 12 | Most potential customers already own one; slotting fees appear | PLC stage | |
| 13 | Customers drifting to a new substitute technology | PLC stage | |
| 14 | Sales flat but profit still strong after a limited-edition flavour | PLC stage + tactic | |

| # | Item | Classification | One-sentence reason (name the tell) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 15 | Sales data are falling although the product is only 6 months old | PLC stage / and what is the tactic | |

> **#3 vs #4 is the pair the exam loves.** An MVP is defined by whether **money changed hands**, not by how finished it looks. And **#14/#15**: a stage is decided by **what the sales data say**, never by how old the technology is — a 40-year-old bicycle is in maturity, and a six-month-old product can already be declining.

**And the free-response rehearsal (this is FRQ 1's shape):**

> *Your teacher asks: **(a)** What was your MVP and what did it cost per unit? **(b)** What behaviour, not opinion, did it produce? **(c)** What did you change because of that result? **(d)** Name one brand element and what it costs a copycat to match.*

Write your four-sentence answer here before submitting:

## Grading Rubric

| Section | Excellent (A) | Good (B) | Developing (C) | Needs Work (D/F) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1 — What you sell** (2.4.A) | Raw material and product stated as two different things with the transformation named; all four prior checkpoints mapped into concrete product requirements | Distinction correct; most links made | Product restated as the input; sources ignored | Not addressed |
| **2 — MVP + fit test** — Unit 2 Task 5 (2.4.A) **[core]** | Design covers functionality/ UX/attributes; scope cut is explicit; **unit cost includes own labour**; hypothesis in strict form with a **falsifiable, behavioural** criterion set in advance and an if-it-fails action; results as money and counts with a base; behaviour kept separate from politeness; **a real change documented**; the limits stated | MVP built and tested; criterion mostly behavioural; cost or verdict partial | "Test" is opinion-based or unfailable; cost missing; verdict asserted | No test, or a verdict with nothing behind it |

| Section | Excellent (A) | Good (B) | Developing (C) | Needs Work (D/F) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **3 — Value proposition + positioning** (2.4.A) | One line with who/what/why-us, each backed by a named finding; positioning written against **both** rivals; every public claim verifiable by the customer or downgraded | Line complete; one rival answered | Generic benefits; claims unprovable | Not addressed |
| **4 — Brand identity** — Unit 2 Task 5 (2.4.B) **[core]** | Two or more identity forms, each justified; three jobs assigned to elements; touchpoint audit shows one voice; **explicit trademark decision and explicit generic-vs-branded decision**; recognition/recall test with pre-set falsifiable criterion, respondents, verdict and limits | Elements built; some jobs assigned; test partial | Logo-only; test is decoration; claims about equity unsupported | Not addressed |
| **5 — Copy stress test** (2.4.C) | Names an element that costs a copier real money, the claim they cannot make without lying, the line you won't cross, and places the stage on sales evidence | Reasonable answer to two of four | Generic "we'll be better" | Not addressed |
| **6 — Exam drill** | All correct with tell-based reasoning; the 4-part FRQ rehearsal complete | Most correct | Several errors | Mostly incorrect |

### Four standing clauses (same as 1C / 2.1)

1. **Asterisked tests must be able to fail**, and **paying is evidence while "sounds good" is not**. Not run = write **PENDING** with the recording plan.
2. **Numbers checkable and consistent** — one unit price, one unit cost, one currency, matching 1.8 and 2.1; own labour priced.
3. **Concept application, not metaphor** — an MVP must be capable of producing a sale; a brand element must do one of the three jobs; a claim must survive the customer asking.
4. **Self-check integrity** — tick only what you can point to in your own document.

## Before You Submit — Three Checks

1. **Search your own PDF** (Ctrl/Cmd+F for a word you typed). If it isn't found, re-export with all fonts embedded, or submit the `.docx`.
2. **Point at every tick.** No template text left in the file (`"_____"`, `"a certain amount"`, `"Due: ___"`). One product name, one customer name, one currency.

3. **Real tables, no screenshots,** and no cell whose text is cut off. Long answers go in the paragraph under the table.

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## Important Notes

1. **Same business idea, same team, same customer** as every prior assignment. If your MVP says something that contradicts your 2.1 profile or your 2.2 tactic, that is a finding — **document the revision** and say which checkpoint was wrong.
2. **Two asterisks in one task.** *MVP used to assess product-market fit* **and** *branding/brand identity* both require hypothesis testing; the *value proposition* does not — it needs research and reasoning. Do not trade them: a brand test is cheap (show five people and ask what promise they heard) and a fit test needs money in the loop.
3. **This is the feed into 2.5 Price.** Section 2's cost per unit, contribution per unit and the price you actually offered at **become** the pricing-strategy input. If you leave 2.4 without a costed unit, 2.5 will be opinion. The tag promised "*half of retail*" — 2.5 asks where the $95 came from.
4. **Negative and partial results are the point.** "Half of 10 paid once and none returned" is a strong answer with a change attached; "everyone loved it" is the weak one. The CED wants the loop, not the win — and 2.4's own lesson is New Coke at scale ($12 million, 200,000 people, pulled in three months) and Dyson's Contra Rotator (great reviews, poor sales, discontinued) plus the cancelled $2.5 billion electric-car programme: **a documented stop is good management, not failure.**
5. **Ethics and claims.** A product sold to classmates is sold to people who trust you, and some of them may be minors. Every claim about health, safety, authenticity or certification must be provable — and where a category is regulated (food, cosmetics, account-based services), the licence is part of the product, not a footnote. If the honest version of your claim would not sell, that is a product problem to fix, not a wording problem.
6. **Case discussion:** [[2.4 Dyson - Case Handout]] — watch "*The Dyson Story*" and note (a) why the **Japan $2,000 G-Force** was an MVP rather than a prototype, (b) why every manufacturer's refusal pushed him to **build his own factory** (1.8 supply chain), (c) which stage failed for the **Contra Rotator** given good reviews, and (d) whether a cancelled **$2.5 billion** project is failure or portfolio management.
7. **Team logistics:** every member must be able to state the unit cost, the fit criterion, the verdict and the brand promise unaided — the exam-day FRQ is written **individually**, and 15% of the score is spent on exactly this project.